

Take a Chance on me!

It was a chance meeting that brought Joann and Chance together. And everyone agrees that it's a case of love at first woof!

We usually think of Joann, our ace interface designer, as somewhat of a tomboy. And you can't blame us—this girl plays the drums, zooms around on her CBZ bike, and kicks some serious butt in *Quake*. Imagine our surprise when she returned from Goa not with a tattoo or a braid, but with a little puppy, peeking out like a baby kangaroo from the rucksack she had slung across her shoulder.

Turns out that on a three-day training session at Synapse (our



training centre in Goa) Joann found the emaciated puppy on the premises. Its hind legs were paralysed and its mother had abandoned it. But it was full of zest, and hopped about on its front legs, winning the hearts of everyone around. Throughout the three days, Joann and Ai Chin of the Multimedia team sneaked away during the session breaks to feed it. When it was time to return to Mumbai, Joann didn't have the heart to leave the little thing behind in some dog shelter, so she decided to bring it back with her. After dozens of

suggestions ranging from the practical 'Doggie' to the classy 'Cloey', the puppy has finally been named Chance.

So Joann's 'one of the guys' image has taken a dent, but she sure is making up for it with a lot of puppy love. Now that the little creature is firmly ensconced in her house, Joann is having to sacrifice some of her 'wild' ways, but one look at the two of them together, and we know she thinks its worth it. She very happily spends all her free time looking after Chance, going back home at lunchtime to check on her little ward and going straight home after work.

Chance has been welcomed with open arms into the Digit family, and was the guest of honour at the last 'girlie party' (Chance is a bitch, so the girls didn't have to break their no-guys-allowed policy. Sigh.) She had a great time being fussed over by all the women, although she was slightly miffed at dinner-time, when she had to have Farex while the big girls ate chicken biryani.

Joann has found plenty of volunteers to baby-sit Chance if she wants to take off once in a while. In fact, one look at those hazel eyes and everyone starts clamouring for their turn to mollycoddle Chance. Except for Jasmine of course. Our International Marketing manager is Joann's roommate and she's learning to live with the puppy, but that doesn't mean she has to like it. Last we heard, she was expressing her disapproval about being woken up with a couple of good ol' doggie licks across her face every morning.

Chance has had a couple of visits to the vet, and is undergoing treatment for her partial paralysis. The vet is not sure if and when this ailment will be cured, but Joann and Chance are willing to take a chance. 🐶

The Web site Story

Once upon a time, there was a guy named Sunil S. Now SS was a writer for you favourite technology magazine, but he had a burning passion for programming for the Web. It is but natural that he should move on to become a full-time programmer for our Web site.

Everything fine so far. Except that his work cycle was such that during the days when the Digit editorial used to be in a tizzy about getting the magazine out, he was

relatively free. And never one to let by an opportunity to tease the rest of the team, SS would put up his feet and taunt every has-sled-looking soul who passed by about how life as a programmer was so much more fun.

That was until the new site launch came along and with it came four days and nights of non-stop work! Of course, the rest of the gang pitched in to do their bit. The writers had a brainstorming session to figure out a name for the site and came up with gems

like 'humsubkadigit.com' and 'merawaladigit.com'. Sunil's co-worker Aalaap G was his usual reliable self. So what if he happened to interchange the Mindware and Playware pages? Then there were the copy editors, who volunteered to insert taglines into the articles to be uploaded. It's another thing that they changed all the <intro> tags to <introduction> in true copydesk style.

But the site is up and running...and they all lived happily ever after.